



Lompoc Locals — Engagement Playbook

How Lompoc Locals engages better: grow the local audience, and turn business owners into paying members who post deals.

Brand essence: community & communication. **Voice:** neighborly, warm, plain-spoken, proud-local, encouraging. Short sentences. Second person. No jargon, no pushy hype. **Site:** <https://lompoc-deals.vercel.app> · Business signup: /for-businesses

Taglines to keep handy:

- Consumer — "All of Lompoc, in one place."
- Community — "Live local. Love Lompoc."
- For businesses — "Get found by the whole valley."
- Shop-local — "We're stronger when we shop local."

1. Goals

Three concrete engagement goals. Everything in this playbook rolls up to one of them.

1. **Grow local subscribers.** Get more Lompoc and Vandenberg neighbors reading the free weekly digest and browsing deals. This is our audience and our proof to businesses.
2. **Get businesses to claim their free listing.** Every restaurant, shop, salon, auto shop, winery, and service in the valley should have a listing. Free listings build the directory and open the door to paid deals later.
3. **Convert claimed listings into paying members.** Move owners from free listing → Standard (\$19.99/mo) to post deals and reach the digest → Premium (\$39.99/mo) for unlimited + featured → digest ad spots (Featured Deal \$49/wk, Sponsor Spotlight \$79/mo, Digest Banner \$99/mo).

Simple way to remember it: **more neighbors reading, more businesses listed, more businesses paying.**

2. Who we're talking to

Two audiences. Same warm voice, different needs.

a) Local shoppers in Lompoc & Vandenberg

- Live in ZIP 93436, 93437, or 93438.
- Want to save money, find something to do this weekend, and support their neighbors.
- Many speak Spanish at home — we engage in **both English and Spanish**.
- Busy. Scroll fast. Trust a familiar local name over a slick ad.

What they care about: real deals, honest reviews from neighbors, "what's new in town," family-friendly picks, and feeling proud of Lompoc.

b) Small-business owners

- Restaurants, shops, salons, auto, wineries, services.
- Busy and **not very tech-savvy** — they run the register, cut the hair, fix the car.
- Skeptical of marketing that costs a lot and does little.

What they care about: getting found by the whole valley, filling slow days, simple and fair pricing, and not wasting time. Show them results, not dashboards.

3. Channels

Practical channels for a small local brand. For each: what it's for, and how to use it.

Instagram + Facebook

- **For:** everyday visibility, deals, community pride, driving digest signups.
- **How:** Post 4–5x/week. Reels and photos of real local places beat graphics. Always caption in a way a neighbor would talk. Put the signup link in bio and pinned. Cross-post the same content to both, but write Facebook a touch longer.

Local Facebook groups ("Lompoc community" pages)

- **For:** reaching neighbors who don't follow us yet.
- **How:** Be a helpful member first, not a billboard. Share a genuinely useful local guide or a great deal, tag the business, and let people ask. Answer every comment. Never spam the same link across groups in one day.

Free weekly email digest

- **For:** our owned audience — the heart of everything. This is what businesses pay to be in.
- **How:** Send the same day and time every week (see cadence below). Lead with the best deals, add one Business Spotlight, one Local Guide link. Keep it skimmable. Every issue has a clear "Subscribe / forward to a neighbor" line and, for owners, a "List your business free" line. Digest also carries paid ad spots — keep them clearly local and tasteful.

In-store flyers + QR codes

- **For:** turning foot traffic into subscribers, and showing owners we drive real people.
- **How:** Give member businesses a small counter flyer/window cling with a QR to their listing and to the digest signup. "Scan to see this week's deals." Bilingual card. It's free marketing for them and signups for us.

Vandenberg SFB community boards

- **For:** reaching the base community — a big, loyal slice of the valley.
- **How:** Post on approved base/family community boards and spouse groups where allowed. Lead with family activities, dining deals, and services. Respect base posting rules; keep it clearly community-minded.

Partnerships (Chamber, events, markets)

- **For:** trust and reach we can't buy.
- **How:** Join the Lompoc Valley Chamber of Commerce. Show up at the farmers market and local events with a table, flyers, and QR codes. Co-brand where it makes sense. A Chamber intro to a business owner converts far better than a cold message.

Word-of-mouth / referrals

- **For:** the cheapest, strongest growth in a small town.
- **How:** Ask happy subscribers to forward the digest. Ask member businesses to refer a neighbor business. Small incentives (see Community tactics). In Lompoc, a recommendation from a friend beats any ad.

4. Content pillars & ideas

Four content pillars, tied to our four messaging pillars. Rotate them so the feed feels varied but on-brand.

Pillar 1 — Community first

Messaging tie: Community first.

- **Community Shoutout:** "Neighbor of the week" — someone who volunteers, coaches, or keeps Lompoc great.
- Repost a local's photo of a Lompoc sunset or the flower fields with credit.
- Highlight a nonprofit fundraiser or blood drive happening this week.
- "Tag a neighbor who'd love this deal" prompts.

Pillar 2 — Local & trusted

Messaging tie: Local & trusted.

- **Business Spotlight:** a short profile of one member business — how long they've been in town, what they're known for.
- **Behind-the-scenes / owner story:** "Meet the family behind [shop]." A 30-second Reel of the owner talking works great.
- "Family-owned in Lompoc since ____" posts.
- Before/after from a local salon, auto shop, or detailer.

Pillar 3 — Real results (get found & sell deals)

Messaging tie: Real results.

- **Deal of the Week:** the single best deal, front and center. Bright, clear, one call to action.
- Roundup: "5 deals under \$10 in Lompoc this week."
- **Local Guides:** "Best tacos in Lompoc," "Where to take the kids this weekend on Vandenberg," "Date night in Lompoc under \$40," "Coffee stops before work."
- "New deal just posted" quick alerts.

Pillar 4 — Simple & fair pricing (business-recruiting)

Messaging tie: Simple & fair pricing.

- "List your business free. Post deals from \$19.99/mo." plain-and-clear graphic.
- Testimonial from an owner: "I filled my slow Tuesday."
- "How it works in 3 steps" carousel for owners.
- Myth-buster: "You don't need to be techy to post a deal. We'll help."

5. Weekly rhythm

Sample 7-day cadence

Day	Channel	Post type
Monday	IG + FB	Deal of the Week (Pillar 3)
Tuesday	IG + FB + a local FB group	Local Guide (e.g., best tacos)
Wednesday	IG + FB	Business Spotlight / owner story (Pillar 2)
Thursday	Weekly email digest send + IG/FB "digest is out" teaser	Digest + deals roundup
Friday	IG + FB	Weekend deals roundup / family activities
Saturday	IG Stories / FB	Community Shoutout + market/event coverage
Sunday	IG + FB (lighter)	Local pride / reshare a neighbor's photo

Post at least one bilingual item (English + short Spanish) every week — usually the Deal of the Week or a Local Guide.

4-week rolling calendar

Week 1 — Food & dining focus

- Mon: Deal of the Week (a restaurant)
- Tue: Guide — "Best tacos in Lompoc" (also drop in a local FB group)
- Wed: Spotlight — a family-owned eatery
- Thu: Digest send (dining deals lead) + teaser
- Fri: Weekend eats roundup
- Sat: Farmers market coverage + shoutout
- Sun: Local pride reshare

Week 2 — Family & Vandenberg focus

- Mon: Deal of the Week (family activity or service)
- Tue: Guide — "Weekend fun for Vandenberg families"
- Wed: Spotlight — a shop or service popular with base families
- Thu: Digest send + Vandenberg community board post
- Fri: Weekend family activities roundup
- Sat: Community Shoutout (a coach, a nonprofit)
- Sun: Local pride reshare

Week 3 — Beauty, auto & services focus

- Mon: Deal of the Week (salon or auto)
- Tue: Guide — "Get ready for summer: local salons, detailers, more"
- Wed: Behind-the-scenes owner story (before/after)
- Thu: Digest send + business-recruiting note in issue
- Fri: "5 services deals this week" roundup
- Sat: Shoutout + event coverage
- Sun: Local pride reshare

Week 4 — Wineries, shops & shop-local focus

- Mon: Deal of the Week (winery or boutique)
- Tue: Guide — "Date night in Lompoc under \$40"
- Wed: Spotlight — a local winery or shop
- Thu: Digest send (shop-local theme) + teaser
- Fri: Weekend shop-local roundup — "*We're stronger when we shop local.*"
- Sat: Community Shoutout + market
- Sun: Local pride reshare + month recap

Then the cycle repeats, refreshed with new businesses and deals.

6. Sample posts

Ready to use. Keep the voice: warm, plain, second person.

1. Deal of the Week (consumer)

👉 Deal of the Week is here, Lompoc. Two tacos and a drink for \$7 at [Business] this week only. Fresh, local, and easy on the wallet. See it and more in one place → link in bio. *All of Lompoc, in one place.*

2. Weekend roundup (consumer)

Weekend plans, sorted. 5 deals under \$10 across Lompoc right now — coffee, tacos, a car wash, and two more. Tag a neighbor who needs this. 📌 Full list in the free weekly digest — subscribe in bio.

3. Bilingual Deal of the Week (consumer)

👉 New deal: 20% off your first cut at [Salon] in Lompoc this week. Live local. Love Lompoc.

👉 Nueva oferta: 20% de descuento en tu primer corte en [Salon] en Lompoc esta semana. Vive local. Ama a Lompoc.

4. Business Spotlight (consumer + trust)

Meet [Owner] of [Business] — family-owned right here in Lompoc for 12 years. They know your name and your order. This is why we shop local. ❤️💜💚 Find them in the directory → link in bio.

5. Business-recruiting (owners)

Own a business in Lompoc or on Vandenberg? Get found by the whole valley. List free today. Post deals and reach our weekly email of local shoppers from just \$19.99/mo. Simple, fair, and made for local. Start at lompoc-deals.vercel.app/for-businesses

6. Bilingual business-recruiting (owners)

Slow week? Fill it. Post a deal and reach hundreds of Lompoc neighbors in our weekly digest. Get found by the whole valley → [/for-businesses](https://for-businesses)

¿Semana lenta? Llénala. Publica una oferta y llega a cientos de vecinos de Lompoc en nuestro boletín semanal. Que todo el valle te encuentre → [/for-businesses](https://for-businesses)

7. Converting businesses

The funnel. Move owners one step at a time. Never oversell — show the next small win.

Claim free listing → Post first deal (Standard \$19.99) → Reach the digest → Upgrade (Premium \$39.99) → Sponsor a featured s

Step 1 — Claim your free listing

- **Ask:** "Get listed free. Takes 5 minutes. We'll help."
- **Nudge:** Show them their category is filling up — "12 Lompoc restaurants are already listed. Claim yours."
- We can pre-build a basic listing and invite the owner to claim it, so the first step feels done.

Step 2 — Post your first deal (Standard, \$19.99/mo)

- **Ask:** "You're listed — now post a deal and start showing up in front of shoppers."
- **Nudge:** "Free listings get found. Deals get sold. Your first deal reaches our weekly digest for \$19.99/mo — cancel anytime."
- Remove the tech fear: offer to set up the first deal with them by phone or in person.

Step 3 — Reach the digest / see results

- The Standard plan already puts them in the weekly digest. Reinforce the win: "Your Tuesday deal went out to the whole valley this morning."
- Share a simple result: views, clicks, or "your deal was one of this week's most-clicked."

Step 4 — Upgrade to Premium (\$39.99/mo)

- **Ask:** "Post as many deals as you want and get featured placement."
- **Nudge:** "You've posted 3 deals this month and hit your limit. Premium is unlimited + featured for \$39.99/mo."

Step 5 — Sponsor a featured spot (digest ads)

- **Featured Deal** — \$49/wk: top of the digest for a week.
- **Sponsor Spotlight** — \$79/mo: a dedicated spotlight block.
- **Digest Banner** — \$99/mo: banner across the digest.
- **Ask:** "Want the whole valley to see you first? Sponsor next week's digest."

Outreach message snippets

Cold intro (warm, local, short):

Hi [Name] — I'm with Lompoc Locals, the local deals site for Lompoc and Vandenberg. We'd love to list [Business] free so neighbors can find you. Takes 5 minutes and I'm happy to set it up for you. Interested?

Nudge to post first deal:

Hi [Name] — you're listed on Lompoc Locals, nice! Want to fill a slow day? For \$19.99/mo you can post a deal that goes out in our weekly email to local shoppers. I can build your first one with you in 10 minutes. Want to try it?

Upgrade nudge:

Hey [Name] — your deals are getting clicks! You've hit your monthly limit. Premium gets you unlimited deals plus featured placement for \$39.99/mo. Want me to switch you over?

8. Community tactics

Community is the brand. These build trust that ads can't.

- **Join the Chamber of Commerce.** Attend mixers. A Chamber intro converts owners far better than a cold call. Offer members a friendly onboarding.
- **Show up in person.** Table at the farmers market and local events with flyers and QR codes. Let people meet a face behind the brand. Sign up subscribers on the spot.
- **Spotlight nonprofits.** Feature a local nonprofit or fundraiser each month for free. Good for the town, good for us. It proves "community first."
- **Vandenberg community.** Support base family events and spouse-run businesses. This community is loyal and refers hard.
- **Referral incentives between businesses.** A member who refers another business that joins gets a free week of Featured Deal placement, or a month of Standard credit. Neighbors bringing neighbors.
- **Subscriber referrals.** "Forward this digest to a neighbor" every week. Occasional small perk — a shoutout, or entry into a local-business gift-card drawing.
- **Co-market with members.** Reshare their posts, tag them, celebrate their milestones ("[Business] just turned 10!"). When they win, we tag along.

Keep it strictly Lompoc + Vandenberg. Our whole promise is "all of Lompoc, in one place" — we don't wander outside the valley.

9. Metrics to watch

A short, honest list. Check weekly.

- **Digest subscribers** — total and net new each week. Our core audience number.
- **Digest open rate & click rate** — is the content landing? Watch which sections get clicks.
- **Listings claimed** — how many businesses are on the directory (free + paid).
- **Deals posted** — total live deals and new deals this week. Signals paid activity.
- **Paid conversions** — free → Standard, Standard → Premium, and ad-spot sales. This is revenue.
- **Top deals** — most-viewed and most-clicked deals each week. Use these as social proof for owners and as our best social content.
- **Social growth & engagement** — follower growth and saves/shares on IG + FB (a lighter signal, but tracks reach).

Rule of thumb: if subscribers are growing and deals posted is growing, the business is healthy. If one stalls, focus the next month there.

Live local. Love Lompoc.